# Theory paper: the pass mark on Harrowgate's paper

Paper to the Board, meeting of 4 November 2026. Laura Kay, Head of Qualifications, with Alan Clayton, Chief Examiner.

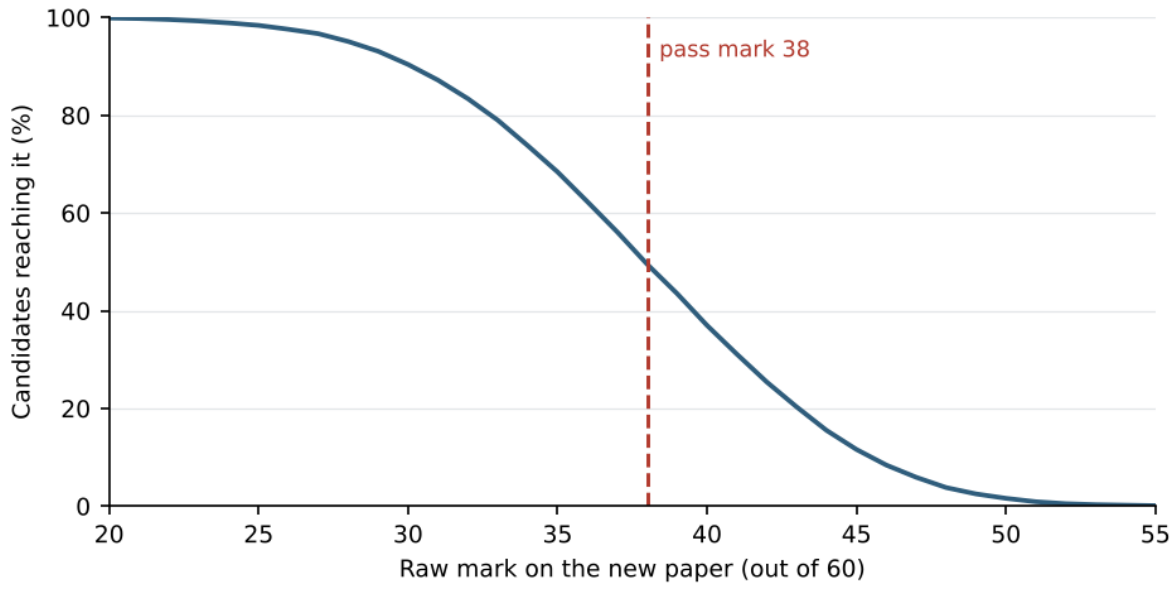
## Recommendation

Set the pass mark on Harrowgate's theory paper at **38 out of 60**, for the held results of April to September 2026 and for every 2027 sitting. It is the mark that holds the standard of 65 on Brindle's scale under AP-3.

## How the standard was carried

The candidates who failed their first sitting on Brindle's paper and sat Harrowgate's paper next are the one group measured on both. A second sitting reads higher than a first on any paper, so their Harrowgate marks were set against what the same candidates would have scored on a second Brindle sitting: Brindle's own resits of 2021 to 2025, matched on the first score, put 28.0 per cent of them at 65 or more. 38 is the lowest raw mark that no more than that share of them reach (25.3 per cent reach 38; 32.2 per cent reach 37).

Carrying last year's first-time pass rate onto this year's first-time candidates would set a higher mark: this year's candidates are a stronger cohort, with more experienced gas engineers coming through the standard route since the autumn, and the summer sittings always draw a stronger mix than the winter ones.




The share of the candidates who sat Harrowgate's paper reaching each raw mark, April to September 2026, with the recommended pass mark.

## The figures the Board asked for

| Month of 2026 | Sitting for the first time | Resitting |
|---|---|---|
| January | 1,065 | 1,471 |
| February | 1,196 | 1,292 |
| March | 1,324 | 1,394 |
| April | 1,308 | 1,211 |
| May | 1,677 | 334 |
| June | 1,895 | 303 |
| July | 1,819 | 313 |
| August | 1,502 | 290 |
| September | 1,813 | 338 |

| Year | First sat Brindle's paper | Passed at that sitting |
|---|---|---|
| 2021 | 6,721 | 3,141 |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 2022 | 7,319 | 3,356 |
| 2023 | 7,913 | 3,743 |
| 2024 | 8,640 | 4,038 |
| 2025 | 10,935 | 5,164 |